Zephyrine Labs - Employee Handbook 2026

1. About the Company

Zephyrine Labs builds weather-forecasting software for small airports and farms. The company was founded in 2017 in Halifax, Canada, by Ines Okafor and Tomas Brandvold. It has 214 employees in three offices: Halifax (headquarters), Lisbon and Kuala Lumpur. Its main product, SkyLedger, gives local weather forecasts that refresh every 10 minutes.

2. Working Hours and Hybrid Work

Employees work in the office on Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Thursdays. Mondays and Fridays are work-from-home days. Core hours are 10:00 to 15:00; outside core hours, schedules are flexible. After six months, employees can ask to work fully remote. Working from another country is allowed for up to 30 days per year, with two weeks' notice to the People team.

3. Annual Leave

Full-time employees get 24 days of paid annual leave per year. Up to 5 unused days can be carried over to the next year, but they must be used by 31 March or they expire. Leave of more than 5 days in a row must be requested at least 4 weeks in advance in the Tidewater HR portal. The office is closed from 24 December to 1 January, and these days do not count as annual leave.

4. Sick Leave and Parental Leave

Employees get 10 paid sick days per year. A doctor's note is needed after 3 sick days in a row. Parental leave is 16 weeks at full pay for all parents, including adoptive parents. Bereavement leave is 5 days for immediate family and 2 days for extended family.

5. Expenses and Travel

Expenses must be submitted in the Ledgerly app within 30 days, with a photo of the receipt. The meal limit is 45 USD per day for domestic trips and 70 USD per day for international trips. Hotels can cost up to 180 USD per night, or 250 USD in London, New York, Tokyo and Singapore. Flights under 6 hours are economy class; flights of 6 hours or more are premium economy. Alcohol is never reimbursed.

6. Equipment and Home Office

Every employee gets a laptop on day one. Engineers can choose a MacBook Pro or a ThinkPad X1 Carbon; everyone else gets a MacBook Air. Laptops are replaced every 3 years. New employees get a one-time 600 USD home office budget and a 40 USD monthly internet allowance. Lost or stolen laptops must be reported to helpdesk@zephyrine.example within 24 hours.

7. Learning and Development

Each employee has a learning budget of 1,500 USD per year for courses, books, certifications and conference tickets. Employees can also take 2 learning days per quarter. Every new hire gets an onboarding buddy for their first 90 days, and can then join the Tailwind mentorship programme.

8. Performance Reviews and Bonus

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in April and October, using the Compass framework. Compass scores four areas from 1 to 5: Impact, Craft, Collaboration and Ownership. Salary increases start on 1 May each year. A company bonus of up to 10% of salary is paid in February if the company hits its revenue target.

9. Security Rules

Multi-factor authentication is required on all company accounts. Passwords must be at least 14 characters and kept in the Keyvault password manager. Security problems, such as clicking a phishing link, must be reported within 1 hour to security@zephyrine.example. Nobody is punished for reporting their own mistake quickly.